VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

# Moringa (drumstick)

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-11

Drought-tolerant, low capital, grows in poor soil and many climates. Income depends on a reliable buyer for pods or leaf.

| DIFFICULTY | MONEY NEEDED | RISK | FIRST RETURN |
|---|---|---|---|
| **2 of 5** | **Low** | **Low** | **first pods about 6-8 months after planting for seed types such as PKM-1** |

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

## In this guide


- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

# Your land at a glance

# Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

**1. Get your soil tested**
Satellite and model data estimate soil pH and texture only roughly, and cannot see nutrients, salinity or soil health. Get a proper soil test (pH, organic carbon, nutrients, salinity) from your KVK or the state soil-testing laboratory; the Soil Health Card scheme provides this. (general knowledge)

**2. Talk to your KVK first**
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

**3. Start small**
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

**4. Line up a buyer before you scale**
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

# Your planting plan for 1 acre

| What | How much | Basis |
|---|---|---|
| Trees at 2.5 m x 2.5 m | **about 647** | your plot size x cited amounts [S1] |
| Compost or farmyard manure per pit | **9.7 tonnes** | your plot size x cited amounts [S1] |
| Seed (about 500 g per hectare) | **0.2 kg** | your plot size x cited amounts [S1] |

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

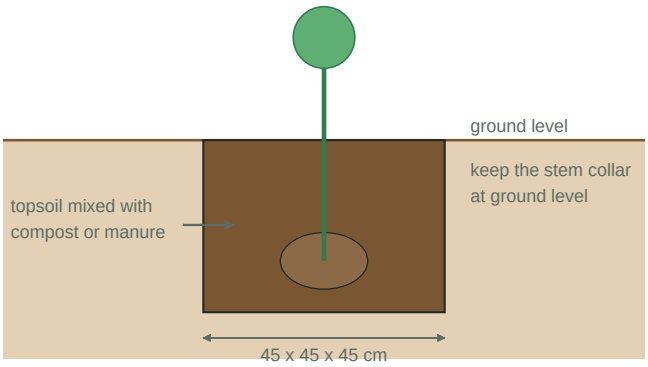
# Planting material

- Annual types such as PKM-1 and PKM-2 (from TNAU) grow from seed; seed rate about 500 g per hectare. Sow two seeds per pit, or raise seedlings in polybags and transplant after 35-40 days. [S1]
- Get seed from a TNAU, ICAR or KVK source so you plant a known variety. (general knowledge)

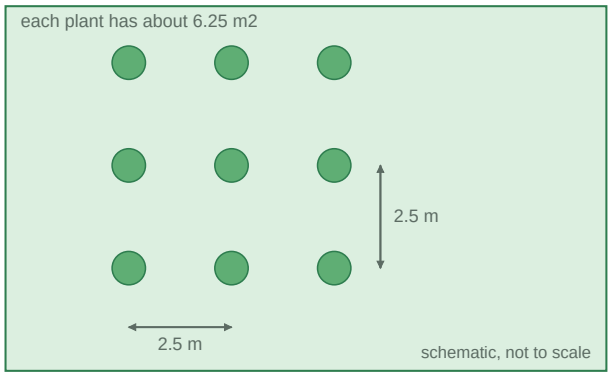
# Land preparation and planting

- Planting season is July to October. Dig pits 45 x 45 x 45 cm at 2.0-2.5 m spacing and mix 15 kg compost or farmyard manure with topsoil in each pit. [S1]
- Closer spacing (for example 1.2 m x 1.2 m for PKM-2) is used for high-density plantings. [S1]

- Pinch the main shoot when seedlings are about 60-80 cm; repeat pinching during the first 3 months to get a bushy, easy-to-harvest tree. [S1, S7, S3]




Planting pit

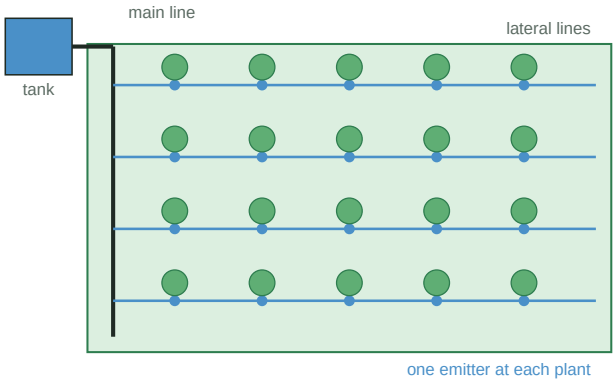



Plant spacing, top view

## Irrigation

- Irrigate before sowing and on the 3rd day, then every 10-15 days depending on soil type. [S8]

- Avoid excess moisture; root rot follows waterlogging. [S3]




Drip irrigation layout (schematic)

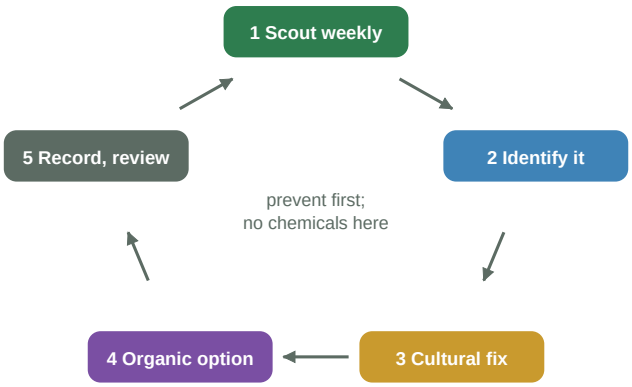
## Nutrition (organic)

- Pit mix of farmyard manure or compost with a little neem cake; repeat compost each year. [S3]
- Mulch the base to conserve moisture. (general knowledge)

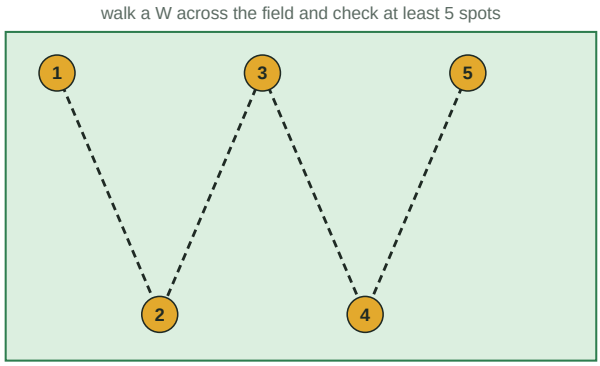
## Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- Main pests: leaf-eating caterpillars, bud worm, termite, aphid, leaf miner and fruit fly; root rot from excess moisture. [S3]
- Hang fermented tomato fruit traps (about 25 per hectare) for pod fly. [S8]
- Scout weekly, pick off caterpillars by hand, keep the field clean, and use neem-based preparations only as a spot treatment. (general knowledge)
- An official AESA-based IPM package for drumstick exists from NIPHM; ask your KVK for it. [S9]

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)




Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review




How to walk the field when scouting

## Monitoring

- Look under leaves and at growing tips weekly for caterpillars, aphids and leaf miner damage; check the trunk base for rot after rain. (general knowledge)
- Record flowering and pod set dates. (general knowledge)

## Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- In a semi-arid western India trial, PKM-2 gave 44.3 kg of fruit per tree and PKM-1 36.7 kg. [S10]
- A KVK page gives an example of about Rs 1.25 lakh net income per acre per year at Rs 10/kg; treat this as one illustrative example with unstated assumptions, not a forecast. [S3]
- Pods are best sold fresh; line up a buyer or a nearby mandi before the first harvest. (general knowledge)

## Risks and costs

- Pod prices swing with the season and glut periods; a few trees for home use plus a small commercial block is a lower-risk start. (general knowledge)
- Rainfall that is continuous gives near-continuous yield; dry spells can be bridged with irrigation. [S11]

## If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Heavy soil** (fixable): Heavy clay stays wet and the tree does not survive prolonged flooding. Plant on mounds or ridges, mix compost into the planting pit, and keep water away from the trunk. [S6, S5]
- **Cold weather** (fixable): It survives only light frost. In frost-prone areas protect young trees (cover, plant in a sheltered spot) or choose another crop. [S4]
- **Low rainfall** (fixable): Drought-tolerant, but flowering and yield improve with irrigation; use drip or basin irrigation in dry areas. [S2, S5]
- **Too much rain** (fixable): It will not survive prolonged flooding. On heavy rain or poor drainage, plant on mounds and keep water away from the trunk. [S6, S5]

- **Soil pH** (fixable): Tolerates a wide pH (5.0-9.0 reported) but best near neutral; add compost and get a soil test. [S6]

### About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of any registered product.

## Sources

**[S1]** https://agritech.tnau.ac.in/horticulture/horti_vegetables_annualmoringa.html
**[S2]** https://hortidata.blogspot.com/2023/01/production-technology-of-moringa.html
**[S3]** https://kvktumakuru2.icar.gov.in/?p=2261
**[S4]** https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/moringa-cultivation/106906356
**[S5]** https://eagriorg.github.io/eagri50/HORT281/pdf/lec32.pdf
**[S6]** https://issuu.com/drumstickmoringa/docs/moringa_-suggested_ways_of_cultivat
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**[S8]** https://www.slideshare.net/SoudipNandi2/production-technology-for-vegetable-and-spices-drumstick-moringa
**[S9]** https://www.niphm.gov.in/IPMPackages/Drumstick.pdf
**[S10]** https://journal.iahs.org.in/index.php/ijh/article/download/1858/493
**[S11]** https://www.agrifarming.in/?p=805

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